

Department of Economics
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MATTI SARVIMÄKI

Academic Positions

Aalto University School of Business, Department of Economics

2022– Associate Professor (with tenure)

2018–22 Assistant Professor

2015–18 Research Fellow

2010–15 Postdoctoral Fellow

VATT Institute for Economic Research

2017– Associate Research Professor (part-time)

2009–16 Senior Researcher / Research Leader

2003–08 Researcher

Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Department of Economics

2011–12 Yrjö Jahnsson Fellow

London School of Economics, SERC and CEP

2008–11 Research Economist (postdoc)

Education

2009 DSc in Economics, Helsinki School of Economics

2003 MSc in Economics, Helsinki School of Economics

2005–06 Visiting PhD student, University College London, Department of Economics

2003 Visiting PhD student, Universidad Carlos III de Madrid, Department of Economics

Other Affiliations

2024– Vice Director, Education for the Future (EDUCA) Flagship, Research Council of Finland

2026– Research Fellow, Rockwool Foundation Berlin (RFBerlin)

2021– Invited Researcher, Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL)

2018– Research Fellow, Institute of Labor Economics (IZA)

2011– External Research Fellow, Centre for Research and Analysis of Migration (CReAM)

Publications

Intergenerational Spillovers of Integration Policies: Evidence from Finland's Integration Plans. *Review of Economics and Statistics*, forthcoming. (with Hanna Pesola)

The Making of Social Democracy: The Economic and Electoral Consequences of Norway's 1936 Folk School Reform. *Journal of the European Economic Association* 23(1): 119–158, 2025. (with Daron Acemoglu, Tuomas Pekkari, and Kjell Salvanes)

Paths to Integration: Earnings, Skill Investments, and Outmigration Across Immigrant Admission Categories. *Scandinavian Journal of Economics* 127(4): 742–764, 2025. (with Hanna Pesola and

Tuomo Virkola)

Social Interaction in the Family: Evidence from Investors' Security Holdings. *Review of Finance* 27(4): 1297–1327, 2023. (with Samuli Knüpfer and Elias Rantapuska)

Habit Formation and the Misallocation of Labor: Evidence from Forced Migrations. *Journal of the European Economic Association* 20(6): 2497–2539, 2022. (with Roope Uusitalo and Markus Jäntti)

Immigration History, Entry Jobs and the Labor Market Integration of Immigrants. *Journal of Economic Geography* 22(3): 581–604, 2022. (with Laura Ansala and Olof Åslund)

The Local Economic Impacts of Regeneration Projects: Evidence from UK's Single Regeneration Budget. *Journal of Urban Economics* 122, 103315, 2021. (with Steve Gibbons and Henry Overman)

Post-Secondary Education and Information on Labor Market Prospects: A Randomized Field Experiment. *Labour Economics* 66, 101888, 2020. (with Sari Pekkala Kerr, Tuomas Pekkariinen and Roope Uusitalo)

Age at Arrival, Parents and Neighborhoods: Understanding the Educational Attainment of Immigrants' Children. *Journal of Economic Geography* 20(2): 459–480, 2020. (with Laura Ansala and Ulla Hämäläinen)

Secular Rise in Economically Valuable Personality Traits. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences* 114(25): 6527–6532, 2017. (with Markus Jokela, Tuomas Pekkariinen, Marko Terviö and Roope Uusitalo)

Formative Experiences and Portfolio Choice: Evidence from the Finnish Great Depression. *Journal of Finance* 72(1): 133–166, 2017. (with Samuli Knüpfer and Elias Rantapuska)

The Evolution of Social Mobility: Norway over the 20th Century. *Scandinavian Journal of Economics* 119(1): 5–33, 2017. (with Tuomas Pekkariinen and Kjell Salvanes)

The Impact of Forced Migration on Mortality: A Cohort Study of 242,075 Finns in 1939–2010. *Epidemiology* 28(4): 587–593, 2017. (with Jari Haukka, Pekka Martikainen and Jaana Suvisaari)

Integrating Immigrants: The Impact of Restructuring Active Labor Market Policies. *Journal of Labor Economics* 34(2): 479–508, 2016. (with Kari Hämäläinen)

Assimilation to a Welfare State: Labour Market Performance and Use of Social Benefits by Immigrants to Finland. *Scandinavian Journal of Economics* 113(3): 665–688, 2011.

Invited Papers

Learning to Experiment: Practical Lessons from Finland's Two-Year Preschool Experiment. *Nordic Economic Policy Review*, 2026, 16(1): 47–86. (with Ramin Izadi)

1990-luvun laman pitkät jäljet. In Eloranta and Uusitalo (eds): *Ankarat ajat. Suomalaisten talouskriisien pitkä historia*. Gaudeamus, 2024. (with Kristiina Huttunen)

Managing Refugee Protection Crises: Policy Lessons from Economics and Political Science. *Journal of the Finnish Economic Association* 2(1): 1–24, 2021. (with Dominik Hangartner and Judith Spirig)

Labor Market Integration of Refugees in Finland. *Nordic Economic Policy Review* 7(1): 91–114, 2017.

Working Papers

Randomization as an Incentive Device: Evidence from Public Procurement of Immigrant Integration Services. (with Hanna Pesola and Tuomo Virkola)

The Local Scarring Effect of Negative Trade Shocks: Evidence from the Collapse of Finnish-Soviet

Trade, 2024. (with Arnaud Costinot and Jon Vogel)

The Impact of Childhood Immigrant Exposure on Adult Intermarriage, 2022. (with Aino Kalmbach and Liam Wren-Lewis)

Forced Migration and Mental Health in post-WWII Finland, 2021. (with Henri Salokangas, Jari Haukka, Pekka Martikainen and Jaana Suvisaari)

Agglomeration in the Periphery (resting), 2011.

Policy Engagement

Principal investigator or scientific lead on large-scale government-commissioned research programs for the Ministry of Education and Culture, Ministry of Economic Affairs and Employment, and the Parliament of Finland. Author of 30+ policy reports (in Finnish, full list [here](#)).

Regularly invited to policy forums and parliamentary committees. Frequent expert media commentator on immigration, education, and labor markets.

Teaching and Supervision

Current courses: Principles of Economics (undergraduate), History of Economic Growth and Crises (graduate), Topics in Labor Economics II (graduate), Economics (EMBA).

Earlier courses: Labor Economics, Labor Economics II, Principles of Empirical Analysis, Integration of Immigrants (Kiel Institute Summer School), International Economics (University of Helsinki).

Doctoral supervision (primary advisor): Lachlan Paterson (ongoing), Matti Sipiläinen (ongoing), Anna Holvio (ongoing), Ellen Sahlström (ongoing), Arttu Kahelin (ongoing, Ministry of Finance), Juuso Mäkinen (2026, Ministry of Finance), Maarit Olkkola (2025, VATT), Aapo Stenhammar (2024, Bonn), Aino Kalmbach (2024, ETLA), Tolga Benzer (2022, U Turku), Ramin Izadi (2022, VATT), Laura Ansala (2018, PTT). *Secondary advisor:* Juho Junttila (ongoing), Lassi Tervonen (2023, FCCA), Isa Kuosmanen (2020, U Geneva), Salla Simola (2020, Storytel), Oskari Harjunen (2019, City of Helsinki), Tuuli Paukkeri (2018, VATT), Riikka Savolainen (2015, Labore).

Graduation year and first placement in parentheses.

Research Funding

2024– co-PI, Education for the Future EDUCA Flagship, Research Council of Finland

2022–25 WP leader, Right to Belong, Strategic Research Council

2021–25 PI, Evaluation of Two-Year Preschool Experiment, Ministry of Education and Culture

2019–23 co-PI, Teachers at Work, J-PAL European Social Inclusion Initiative

2015–21 WP leader, Preventing Social Exclusion, Strategic Research Council

2009–14 WP leader, Migration: Integration, Impact and Interaction, NORFACE

Personal grants from Yrjö Jahnsson Foundation, Jenny and Antti Wihuri Foundation, Palkansaajasäätiö, Eemil Aaltonen Foundation, and OP-Pohjola Foundation.

Awards and Honors

2024 Aalto Research Impact Award

2021 Teacher of the Year, Aalto University Business Students Association (KY)

2021 Best Reviewer Award, *Labour Economics*

2020 Best Referee Award, *Journal of Economic Geography*

2019 Teacher of the Year, Aalto University School of Business

- 2010 Representative of Social Sciences, Academy Club for Young Scientists, Finnish Academy of Science and Letters
 2010 Doctoral Thesis Award, Helsinki School of Economics

Service

- 2025– Vice-Chair, Urban Policy Council
 2023– Director of the BSc Program, Department of Economics, Aalto
 2022–23 President, Finnish Economic Association (Vice President 2021–22)

Frequent referee for journals in economics and related fields, including *AEJ: Applied Economics*, *AEJ: Economic Policy*, *American Economic Review*, *AER: Insights, Demography*, *Economic Journal*, *Econometrica*, *Journal of Development Economics*, *Journal of Human Resources*, *Journal of Labor Economics*, *Journal of Public Economics*, *Journal of the European Economic Association*, *Journal of Urban Economics*, *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, *Review of Economic Studies*, and *Review of Economics and Statistics*, among others. Guest editor, *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*.

Opponent for doctoral theses: Sanni Kiviholma (Jyväskylä), Tapio Haaga (Turku), Trine Skriver Høholt Jensen (Aarhus), Laura Kivi (Tartu), Sébastien Willis (UPF). External pre-examiner: Henrik Andersson (Uppsala), Per Olof Robling (Stockholm), Martin Nilsson (Uppsala).

Last updated: September 2026